

DUY NGUYEN

✉ duykng@cs.unc.edu

🌐 duykhuongnguyen.github.io

🐙 github.com/duykhuongnguyen

Research Interests

My research aims to develop capable, trustworthy, and adaptive AI systems, with a focus on large language models (LLMs) and autonomous agents. My current interests include advancing LLM reasoning, developing safety and security mechanisms for agentic systems, and designing evolving agents that continually update their knowledge, memory, and behavior.

Education

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Aug. 2024 – Present

Chapel Hill, NC, USA

- Advisor: Prof. Mohit Bansal

Hanoi University of Science and Technology

B.S. in Computer Science

Sep. 2018 – Sep. 2022

Hanoi, Vietnam

- GPA: 3.65/4.00; graduated with Excellent Degree

Publications

Duy Nguyen, Archiki Prasad, Elias Stengel-Eskin, Mohit Bansal. GrAIInS: Gradient-based Attribution for Inference-Time Steering of LLMs and VLMs. In *Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2026. [\[pdf\]](#)

Duy Nguyen*, Archiki Prasad*, Elias Stengel-Eskin, Mohit Bansal. LAsER: Learning to Adaptively Select Reward Models with Multi-Armed Bandits. In *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2025. [\[pdf\]](#)

Duy Nguyen, Archiki Prasad, Elias Stengel-Eskin, Mohit Bansal. Multi-Attribute Steering of Language Models via Targeted Intervention. In *Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2025. [\[pdf\]](#)

Bao Nguyen, Binh Nguyen, **Duy Nguyen**, Viet Anh Nguyen. Distributional Surgery for Language Model Activations. In *Findings of the Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (Findings of EMNLP)*, 2025. [\[pdf\]](#)

Ngoc Bui, **Duy Nguyen**, Man-Chung Yue, Viet Anh Nguyen. Coverage-Validity-Aware Algorithmic Recourse. In *Operations Research*, 2025. [\[pdf\]](#)

Hieu Nguyen, **Duy Nguyen**, Khoa Doan, Viet Anh Nguyen. Cold-start Recommendation by Personalized Embedding Region Elicitation. In *Conference on Uncertainty in Artificial Intelligence (UAI)*, 2024. [\[pdf\]](#)

Duy Nguyen, Ngoc Bui, Viet Anh Nguyen. Distributionally Robust Recourse Action. In *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2023. [\[pdf\]](#)

Duy Nguyen, Ngoc Bui, Viet Anh Nguyen. Feasible Recourse Plan via Diverse Interpolation. In *International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS)*, 2023. [\[pdf\]](#)

Ngoc Bui, **Duy Nguyen**, Viet Anh Nguyen. Counterfactual Plans under Distributional Ambiguity. In *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2022. [\[pdf\]](#)

Tuan-Duy H. Nguyen, Ngoc Bui, **Duy Nguyen**, Man-Chung Yue, Viet Anh Nguyen. Robust Bayesian Recourse. In *Conference on Uncertainty in Artificial Intelligence (UAI)*, 2022. [\[pdf\]](#)

* denotes equal contribution.

Preprints

Duy Nguyen, Hanqi Xiao, Archiki Prasad, Zaid Khan, Anirban Das, Austin Zhang, Sambit Sahu, Hyunji Lee, Elias Stengel-Eskin, Mohit Bansal. AVSD: Adaptive-View Self-Distillation by Balancing Consensus and Teacher-Specific Privileged Signals. *Under Review*. [\[pdf\]](#)

Duy Nguyen, Hanqi Xiao, Archiki Prasad, Elias Stengel-Eskin, Hyunji Lee, Mohit Bansal. Conflict-Resolving and Sharpness-Aware Minimization for Generalized Knowledge Editing with Multiple Updates. *Under Review*. [\[pdf\]](#)

Duy Nguyen, Bao Nguyen, Viet Anh Nguyen. Cost-Adaptive Recourse Recommendation by Adaptive Preference Elicitation. *Forever Preprint*. [\[pdf\]](#)

Experience

Google Cloud AI Research <i>Student Researcher</i>	May 2026 – Present <i>Sunnyvale, CA, USA</i>
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- Research topics: LLM agent safety and security

Amazon Science <i>Applied Scientist Intern</i>	May 2025 – Aug. 2025 <i>Seattle, WA, USA</i>
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- Research topics: LLM reasoning for structured and tabular data

VinAI Research (now Qualcomm AI Research) <i>Research Resident</i>	Aug. 2022 – Aug. 2024 <i>Hanoi, Vietnam</i>
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- Advisor: Prof. Viet Anh Nguyen
- Research topics: LLM safety, interpretability, and explainability

Honors and Awards

NeurIPS 2025 Scholar Award <i>NeurIPS</i>	Oct. 2025
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Honorable Mention – Undergraduate Operations Research Prize <i>INFORMS</i>	Oct. 2022
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Best Thesis Presentation Award <i>School of Information and Communication Technology, HUST</i>	Aug. 2022
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Excellence Scholarship for the Academic Year <i>School of Information and Communication Technology, HUST</i>	Sep. 2019
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Academic Service

Reviewer for ICLR (2025–2026), ICML (2025–2026), NeurIPS (2023–2026), and ACL Rolling Review (2025–2026).